2011 Ford Fusion SEL 2.5L

$8,170 · 119,219 miles · Dealer · Ridgecrest, CA

Seller: American Dream Auto Sales (Ed), 239 E Ridgecrest Blvd

Source: AutosToday

Listing: https://www.autostoday.com/cars-for-sale/used-cars/listing/3FAHP0JA4BR304737/2011-ford-fusion-sel-i-4-ridgecrest-ca

Report generated October 26, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









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Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$9,292	**$551**	**Average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	3/5 · 9 recalls · 2,794 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$8,170.00
Sales tax (9.25%)	$755.73
Dealer doc + filing fees	$125.00
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$53.10
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$65.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$9,291.83
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$5,000.00
Amount financed	$4,291.83
Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR)	$86.00
Total interest over the loan	$868.14
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$5,150.00

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$86.00
Insurance (estimate, full)	$135.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 26 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$182.69
Maintenance & repair reserve	$130.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$16.93
Total per month	$550.62

Running costs without the loan: **$465/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$15,314** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Average (3/5)

Average-to-good drivetrain (2.5L + 6-speed), but 2011 Fusion has 2,794 NHTSA complaints - over half about the electric power steering failing. The CA cars were not included in Ford's steering recall.

NHTSA data for this model year: 9 recalls · 2,794 owner complaints (80 involving a crash). Most complaints: Steering (1435), Air Bags (330), Engine (276), Power Train (268), Vehicle Speed Control (256), Electrical System (203).

Known issues for this model

• Electric power steering failure ('Steering assist fault', heavy steering) - most-complained item

• Transmission harsh shifts / shudder at high miles

• Throttle body issues (reduced power mode)

• Ex-rental/fleet: hard use

Check on this car before buying

• Ask if the steering rack/EPAS was replaced

• Test drive: any steering warning, notchy or heavy steering

• Shift quality cold and warm

• Run VIN for 9 recalls

Notes

Dealer stock #11256. Red/black, 2.5L 4-cyl (the good engine), 6-speed auto. Clean title, ACCIDENT FREE, lease/rental/fleet history.

Price: $8,170, 31% above market avg $6,224 ('Poor buy'). 137 days on lot, price RAISED $615. Target ~$6,300. Dealer est. out-the-door $9,147.

2010-12 Fusion 2.5 is one of the more dependable midsize sedans of its era, but ~23 city MPG costs more in gas for DoorDash.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.